

Product Intern Assignment

Product Teardown: Subspace.money

Optimizing the Subscription Economy

Role Applied For: Product Intern

Date: May 31, 2026

My Subscriptions

Netflix Premium

₹149/mo



Prime Video

₹49/mo



Spotify Family

₹35/mo

Total Savings: ₹850/mo

Executive Summary: The "Splitwise for OTT" Opportunity

WHY SUBSPACE?

Subspace tackles the high cost of fragmented OTT services in India, a massive market with high price sensitivity and growing digital consumption.

PRODUCT SUMMARY

A subscription management and sharing platform that enables users to co-pay for premium services legally and securely through a localized marketplace.

PRODUCT THESIS

Subspace can transition from a "savings tool" to a "lifestyle hub" by solving the trust gap in P2P subscription sharing.

HEADLINE TAKEAWAYS



Market Fit: Strong value proposition in a price-conscious market like India with high growth potential.



UX Friction: Significant friction during the "discovery to purchase" flow hampers conversion.



Trust Moat: Security and fraud prevention are the ultimate moats for this business model.

Product Overview & Research Methodology

WHAT SUBSPACE DOES

Subspace provides a localized marketplace for OTT and software subscriptions, offering automated cost-sharing features for Indian consumers.

CORE FEATURES

- ✓ Subscription Tracking & Management
- ✓ Automated Split Payments (UPI)
- ✓ Verified Group Sharing Marketplace
- ✓ Discounted Bundled Plans
- ✓ Direct OTT Activation

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

- 01 Live Product Testing:** Full walkthrough from landing page to group discovery and plan selection.
- 02 Benchmarking:** Competitive analysis against Fleek, TogetherPrice, and manual sharing methods.
- 03 Secondary Research:** Analysis of user reviews on Play Store, Reddit, and Trustpilot.

FRAMEWORKS USED

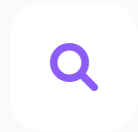
SWOT Analysis

User Journey Mapping

Competitive Matrix

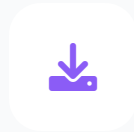
Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD)

User Journey: From Curiosity to Friction



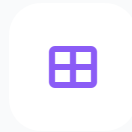
Landing Page

Initial discovery of value prop



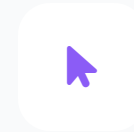
App Download

Onboarding & registration



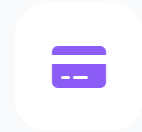
Discovery

Browsing categories & plans



Selection

Choosing a group to join



Payment

UPI split & access grant

CRITICAL FRICTION POINTS

Discovery

Overwhelming number of "inactive" or "full" groups creates a "dead mall" feel, discouraging new users.

Onboarding

High friction in linking existing accounts; users fear account bans from primary providers.

Trust

Lack of clear verification for "Group Admins" leads to significant scam anxiety during payment.

 The "Aha" Moment: Realizing a ₹199/month plan can be shared for just ₹50/month.

Market Positioning & Competitive Landscape

IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE (ICP)

The "Digital Optimizer"

Gen-Z students and early-career professionals in Tier 1/2 Indian cities. Tech-savvy, price-sensitive, and heavy consumers of multiple OTT platforms.

JOB-TO-BE-DONE (JTBD)

Safe & Seamless Access

"Help me access premium content without the premium price tag, safely and without the hassle of chasing friends for money."

COMPETITOR	TARGET USER	CORE STRENGTH	KEY WEAKNESS
Fleek	OTT Heavy Users	Sleek UI & Brand	Limited sharing logic
TogetherPrice	Global Users	Established Trust	High fees for India
Splitwise	General Users	Ubiquitous Usage	No automated payment
Subspace	Indian Savers	Localized UPI Flow	UI Bugs & Trust Gap

SWOT Snapshot: Setting the Stage for Feedback

+ STRENGTHS

- First-mover advantage in the Indian subscription-sharing market.
- Deep integration with local payment methods (UPI) for seamless splits.
- Established user base and high brand recall among Gen-Z "savers."

– WEAKNESSES

- Inconsistent UI/UX leading to friction in the discovery-to-purchase flow.
- Presence of fraudulent listings hurting platform trust and reliability.
- Slow customer support response times for transaction disputes.

💡 OPPORTUNITIES

- Expanding into B2B sharing for SaaS tools targeting startups.
- Strategic partnerships with ISPs and Telcos for bundled offerings.
- Gamification of savings to increase Daily Active Usage (DAU).

⚠️ THREATS

- Stricter anti-password sharing policies from major OTT providers.
- Emergence of "super-apps" integrating native subscription management.
- Regulatory changes regarding P2P financial transactions in India.

**This analysis frames the 5 key feedback points presented in the following slides.*

Feedback 1: UX — Streamlining Group Discovery

OBSERVED

Discovery Friction

The "Marketplace" page lists hundreds of groups without clear "Active" or "Available Spots" filters at the top level. Users must click into individual listings to check availability.

PROBLEM

The "Dead Mall" Effect

Users spend 3-5 minutes clicking into groups only to find they are full or inactive. This repetitive failure leads to high bounce rates and a perception of low platform liquidity.

SHIP INSTEAD

Smart Availability

- **Default Filters:** Only show groups with >1 available spot by default.
- **Real-time Status:** Add "Verified Active" badges for groups with high-rated admins.
- **Quick Join:** One-tap join from the marketplace view.

EXPECTED IMPACT: 20% Increase in "Plan Selection" Conversion Rate

Feedback 2: Trust - Verified Admin Program

🔍 OBSERVED

User reports on Reddit and Play Store highlight "scammers" who collect split payments and then change passwords or delete groups immediately.

❗ PROBLEM

A single bad experience destroys the platform's core value proposition: "**Safe Sharing.**" High anxiety during the joining phase leads to drop-offs.

🔑 SHIP INSTEAD

- ✓ **Escrow Payments:** Hold funds for 48h; release only after the joiner confirms access.
- ✓ **Verified Admins:** Mandatory KYC for "Power Admins" managing >3 groups.

60% Reduction

Projected decrease in fraud reports and increase in User LTV.

Feedback 3: GTM — Clarity in Pricing & Fees

OBSERVED

PROBLEM

The "Hidden Fee" Friction

The service fee structure is buried in the final payment screen and varies inconsistently across plans.

"Users feel 'tricked' when the advertised ₹50 becomes ₹65 at checkout, hurting brand integrity and trust."

SHIP INSTEAD

Transparent Value Delivery

- **Upfront Pricing:** Show "Total Cost" (Subscription + Platform Fee) clearly on the marketplace cards.
- **Subspace Plus:** Introduce a monthly pass (e.g., ₹29/mo) that waives all per-transaction fees for power users.
- **Fee Breakdown:** Provide a simple tooltip explaining the platform's value-add (escrow, support, etc.).

15% ↑ Improvement in Checkout Completion Rate

Feedback 4: Collaboration — "Family" Circles

OBSERVED & PROBLEM

The "Stranger" Interface

Users who share with real-life friends still use the app, but the interface treats them like strangers. There is no distinction between a P2P marketplace transaction and a trusted social group.

Problem: Missed opportunity to become the "OS for the household" and drive organic viral growth through social circles.

SHIP INSTEAD

Trusted Circle Mode

-  **Circle Mode:** A dedicated UI for "Trusted Circles" (Friends/Family) with lower platform fees and a unified monthly bill.
-  **Auto-Reminders:** Integrated WhatsApp bot to nudge friends who haven't paid their share, removing social awkwardness.

PROJECTED STRATEGIC IMPACT

High
Organic Referral Rate

30%
Increase in Retention

Prioritization & Roadmap



01

Phase 1: Foundation (Trust & UX)

Immediate focus on Escrow payments and Discovery filters to stabilize the core funnel and reduce churn.

02

Phase 2: Transparency (GTM)

Implement upfront pricing to build brand integrity and improve checkout completion rates.

03

Phase 3: Growth (Retention)

Introduce the savings tracker and milestone rewards to drive DAU and long-term LTV.

**Rationale: Prioritizing "Day-1 Execution" items that directly impact trust and conversion.*

FINAL RECOMMENDATION

Solving for "Zero Friction" via Trust-First Infrastructure

Immediate Priority

Escrow

Implement an Escrow Payment System to eliminate fraud and build the ultimate competitive moat.

Success Metric

40+ NPS

Targeting a significant increase in Net Promoter Score by reducing transaction anxiety and disputes.

Product Thinking

Trust

Shifting from a "Marketplace" to a "Trusted Intermediary" to dominate the Indian subscription economy.

"Subspace has the right idea at the right time. By solving for trust, it becomes the OS for the household."